



ALUMNI SCHOOLS GOLF CHALLENGE

TOURNAMENT RULES, REGULATIONS AND CONDITIONS

INAUGURAL SEASON 2026/27

Celebrating excellence. Competing exclusively. Honouring tradition.

Foreword

Welcome to the inaugural Alumni Schools Golf Challenge! We are thrilled to launch this exciting, purely competitive tournament that brings together alumni from South African schools to celebrate our shared traditions, excellence on the course, and the spirit of friendly rivalry. Whether you are teeing off for bragging rights or aiming for the SA Final, we aim to create an enjoyable, fair, and memorable experience for everyone involved. Thank you for joining us — let's make this season unforgettable!

1. Introduction

- 1.1 The Alumni Schools Golf Challenge is a fun, schools-based golf tournament exclusively for alumni of South African schools.
- 1.2 It is played in Better Ball Matchplay format across divisions and managed entirely through our custom and mobile-friendly website.
- 1.3 Registration opens on 2 April 2026.
- 1.4 By registering, you agree to these guidelines in full — we appreciate your participation!

2. Overview and General Terms & Conditions

- 2.1 We aim to build a tournament known for its integrity and enjoyment. We reserve the right of admission.
- 2.2 This is purely about competition, great golf and rekindling old friendships.
- 2.3 **The Coordinators and Organizers – in coordination with the sponsors, reserve the right to change, amend or add any tournament rules, regulations, and conditions they deem required necessary to ensure the successful running of the Tournament.**

3. Team Compilation and Substitutions

- 3.1 Both players must be from the same school and each player should have spent a minimum of 3 years in the school they are representing.
- 3.2 If a player in a pair cannot play in any round due to health, bereavement, business or other reasons, a substitution is allowed with another Bonafide alumnus from the same school.



- 3.3 A team is only allowed one substitution per season. Once a player is substituted, they cannot go back into that team.
- 3.4 The team who played in the Divisional Final to win their place in the SA Final cannot substitute a player for the SA Final.
- 3.5 Admin must be informed immediately and must approve the substitution.
- 3.6 If a qualified pair cannot attend the SA Final, their spot goes to the team they defeated in the last round.
- 3.7 Winners proudly represent their school at the SA Final.

3. Measuring Devices

- 3.1 Players may use distance-measuring devices for yardages only.
- 3.2 Penalties apply if devices are used to measure slope, wind, temperature or other conditions, per the Rules of Golf.

4. Player Eligibility

4.1 General Requirements

- 4.1.1 Participants must be former pupils of the same school and attended the school for a minimum of 3 years (no longer enrolled as a learner in 2026 or later seasons).
- 4.1.2 Participants must hold a valid active Golf RSA Handicapping Network Africa (HNA) handicap.
- 4.1.3 Participants must provide a valid handicap registration number during registration.
- 4.1.4 Participants must clear eligibility.
- 4.1.5 Participants must be in good standing at their club.
- 4.1.6 Participants must be at least 18 years old.

4.2 Ineligibility

- 4.2.1 Viewer-only access applies if any requirement is not met or if admin rejects eligibility.

4.3 Verification

- 4.3.1 Admin handles verification kindly and may request additional documents if needed.
- 4.3.2 Handicap verification involves cross-checking the HNA number against the official database for activity and accuracy.
 - 4.3.2.1 If discrepancies arise (e.g., inactive handicap or unusual changes), admin may request recent score history, club confirmation or proof of updates to ensure fairness.
 - 4.3.2.2 This process is quick and supportive — contact us with any questions.

5. Registration



5.1 Registration opens on 2 April 2026 and closes on 1 August 2026 — all via the web-app.

5.2 Players are asked to provide:

full name,
email address,
South African mobile number,
HNA handicap number,
school name,
current handicap,
city/town of residence,
and postal code.

5.2.1 It is critically important that the correct city/town and **100% accurate postal code** are provided during registration. Geo-plotting for division assignments and Partner Pool matching is done **entirely based on the postal code entered**. Any inaccuracy may result in incorrect grouping or matching — please double-check and ensure it is correct. We cannot stress this enough.

5.3 Teams consist of two players from the same school (mixed, all-male or all-female allowed; no limit on teams per school).

5.4 Teams form via partner invite (Player 1 invites Player 2 via name and mobile or email) or Partner Pool (admin/app matches by same school first, then approximately 50 km radius via postal code).

5.5 New schools can be added instantly in the app; admin confirms later without delaying players.

6. Entry Fees and Payment

6.1 Entry fees are R1,500 per player (R3,000 per team).

6.2 Payment is by electronic payment portal or EFT.

6.3 Once a team is paid and included in the draw, no refunds are issued.

7. Tournament Format

7.1 The format is Better Ball Matchplay throughout.

7.2 Divisions are assigned by geo-plotting for convenience (closest teams together where possible); each division has exactly 8 teams. **Postal code is used for geo-plotting** and therefore needs to be 100% correct — please ensure accuracy during registration. We cannot stress this enough.

7.3 Divisions are named Division 1, Division 2, Division 3, etc., but may be sponsored and renamed per the sponsor's request (sponsorship opportunities available).

7.4 Bracket Structure per Division (Double-Elimination Style)

7.4.1 Round 1: Four matches among 8 teams produce 4 winners to Winners Bracket and 4 losers to 2nd Chance Bracket.

7.4.2 Round 2: Two matches in Winners Bracket and two matches in 2nd Chance Bracket.



7.4.3 Round 3: The two undefeated teams from Winners Bracket Round 2 receive a bye to the semi-finals; two matches occur (winners of 2nd Chance Round 2 vs losers of Winners Round 2).

7.4.4 Round 4 (Semi-Finals): Two matches (Round 3 winners vs bye teams).

7.4.5 Round 5 (Division Final): One match to determine the division winner (no rematch).

7.4.6 A team is eliminated after two losses.

7.5 Round 6

7.5.1 Division winners are paired for playoffs (every two division winners play off).

7.5.2 If the number of divisions is odd, a 3-way playoff determines the remaining two SA Final spots.

7.5.3 Winners advance to the SA Final.

7.6 Home and Away

7.6.1 Home and away designations are drawn at the start of each round.

7.6.2 The home team books a GolfRSA-affiliated 18-hole or 9-hole course and confirms tee time (unless otherwise agreed).

7.6.3 If the home team cannot book, the match occurs at the away team's club or a mutually agreed neutral course.

7.6.4 Local rules of the host course apply.

7.6.5 It is requested that home teams negotiate the cheapest possible rate with their club for the visiting team.

7.6.6 Each team is responsible for their own cost on the day of the match.

7.6.7 See addendum 1 - **UNIFIED MATCH DAY PROTOCOL**

8. Sample Bracket Diagram

8.1 The following is a clear representation of the bracket structure for a typical division (and Round 6 example).

TOURNAMENT STRUCTURE

Alumni Schools Golf Challenge

DIVISION BRACKET — INAUGURAL SEASON 2026/27

■ Winners Bracket ■ 2nd Chance Bracket ■ Mixed (Cross-bracket)

Division

ROUND 1 · 10 AUG – 6 SEP 2026



G1: Team 1
vs Team 2

G2: Team 3
vs Team 4

G3: Team 5
vs Team 6

G4: Team 7
vs Team 8

4 winners advance to Winners Bracket · 4 losers drop to 2nd Chance Bracket

ROUND 2 · 11 SEP – 18 OCT 2026

2ND CHANCE BRACKET

Loss G1 vs Loss G2
2ND CHANCE

Loss G3 vs Loss G4
2ND CHANCE

WINNERS BRACKET

Win G1 vs Win G2
WINNERS

Win G3 vs Win G4
WINNERS

2nd Chance losers eliminated · Winners Bracket losers drop to 2nd Chance

ROUND 3 · 23 OCT – 29 NOV 2026

Win Rd2 G1 **2ND CH**



VS

Loss Rd2 G3 WINNERS

CROSS-BRACKET

Win Rd2 G2 2ND CH

VS

Loss Rd2 G4 WINNERS

CROSS-BRACKET

Byes: 2 undefeated Winners Bracket teams advance directly to Round 4 (Semi-Finals)

ROUND 4 · SEMI-FINALS · 4 DEC 2026 – 24 JAN 2027

Win Rd3 G1

VS **Bye Team 1** BYE

Win Rd3 G2

VS **Bye Team 2** BYE

ROUND 5 · DIVISION FINAL · 31 JAN – 28 FEB 2027

Win Rd4 G1 VS **Win Rd4 G2**



DIVISION WINNER

Division 2 follows the same bracket structure, producing a Division 2 Winner.

ROUND 6 · SA FINAL QUALIFIER · 5 MAR – 11 APR 2027

Division Winner VS **Division Winner**



SA FINAL QUALIFIER

If the number of divisions is odd, a 3-way playoff determines the remaining SA Final spots.



SA FINAL · MID-MAY 2027



How the Double-Elimination Bracket Works

- **Round 1:** Four matches among 8 teams. Winners enter the Winners Bracket; losers enter the 2nd Chance Bracket.
- **Round 2:** Two matches in the Winners Bracket and two in the 2nd Chance Bracket.
- **Round 3:** The two undefeated Winners Bracket teams receive a bye to the Semi-Finals. Two cross-bracket matches are played (2nd Chance winners vs Winners Bracket losers).
- **Round 4 – Semi-Finals:** Round 3 winners face the two bye teams.
- **Round 5 – Division Final:** One match determines the Division Winner. No rematch.
- **Elimination rule:** A team is eliminated after two losses.

9. Handicaps and Scoring

9.1 Handicap Calculation

9.1.1 Course Handicap is determined per World Handicap System rules using Handicap Index, Slope Rating, Course Rating, and tee selected (as published at the club or in the HNA app).

9.1.2 90% allowance is applied to each player's Course Handicap and rounded to the nearest whole number (0.5 and above rounds up).

9.1.3 Maximum playing handicap is 24 for men and 28 for women (higher handicaps play off the cap).

9.1.4 In a match, the lowest 90% Course Handicap among the four players is set to scratch; other players receive strokes equal to the difference.

9.1.4.i Explanation — Match Play Better ball (Handicap Application)

In a match, each player first calculates **90% of their Course Handicap**.

The player with the **lowest adjusted handicap (90%)** plays **off scratch (0)**.

All other players receive strokes based on the **difference between their handicap and the lowest player's handicap**.

Example Scenario:

Player	Course Handicap	90% Allowance	Playing Handicap
Player A	10	9	0 (lowest — plays off scratch)
Player B	14	13	4 (13 – 9)
Player C	18	16	7 (16 – 9)
Player D	22	20	11 (20 – 9)

How it works in the match:

Player A (lowest) = **0 strokes**

Player B = receives **4 strokes**

Player C = receives **7 strokes**



Player D = receives **11 strokes**

These strokes are allocated on the **stroke index holes** (hardest holes first).

Simple Summary (for players):

Take **90% of your handicap**.

Lowest player goes to **0**.

Everyone else gets the **difference**.

Strokes are given on the **hardest holes**.

9.2 Tee Selection

9.2.1 Players and team members may select different tees. Handicaps are reflected and published at the course or in the HNA app — the app displays these but does not adjust them automatically.

9.3 Scoring Format

9.3.1 The better (lower net) team score on each hole counts.

9.3.2 The hole is won by the team with the lower net score or halved if equal.

9.3.3 The match is won by the team that is more holes up than holes remaining.

9.4 Score Submission

9.4.1 Scores are entered hole-by-hole in the app (at least one player per team).

9.4.2 Manual scorecards are mandatory and serve as the official legal document.

9.4.3 Both teams must photograph and keep their scorecards.

9.4.4 In case of dispute, both teams upload their scorecards to admin for review.

10. Tied Matches and Countback

10.1 All Square after 18 holes results in sudden death playoff starting from Hole 1 or the next available hole as allocated by the club.

10.2 If a sudden death playoff is not possible, use a countback from hole 18. If all 18 holes are not completed, then count back from hole 17 (or the last completed hole); the team that was last in the lead wins.

10.3 If that is not possible, the winner will be determined by a chip-off. Nearest to the pin wins.

11. Match Scheduling

11.1 Round Windows

11.1.1 Round 1: 10 August 2026 to 6 September 2026

11.1.2 Round 2: 11 September 2026 to 18 October 2026

11.1.3 Round 3: 23 October 2026 to 29 November 2026

11.1.4 Round 4: 4 December 2026 to 24 January 2027

11.1.5 Round 5: 31 January 2027 to 28 February 2027



11.1.6 Round 6: 5 March 2027 to 11 April 2027
SA Final middle May TBA

11.2 Arrangement

11.2.1 Teams contact opponents via app chat and agree on date, time and venue within the window (details recorded in app).

11.3 Failure to Complete

11.3.1 If weather prevents a match from starting, a new date is allocated within the window if time allows.

11.3.1.1 If insufficient time remains, the win is awarded to the team with the fewest losses overall.

11.3.1.2 If losses are tied, a lucky draw determines the winner.

11.3.2 Admin may award a result fairly if no completion occurs and evidence (e.g., scheduling attempts) is reviewed.

12. Disputes and Appeals

12.1 In case a rule dispute cannot be resolved on the course, or by the course marshal or club representative during or after the game, log a dispute in the app.

12.2 Disputes are flagged directly in the app.

12.3 Admin reviews scorecards and seeks clarification from both teams.

12.4 Admin decisions are final.

12.5 An appeal process is built into the app for any queries, disputes or concerns.

12.5.1 Players can contact admin directly from the app at any time with questions or to initiate an appeal.

12.5.2 All communications and resolutions are handled promptly and transparently through the app.

13. SA Final

13.1 The SA Final follows professional standards with no count-outs; ties are settled by playoff if possible.

13.2 Details (format, number of qualifiers, bracket, venue, dates) will be published by end August 2026 and depend on total entries.

13.3 It is a multi-day event (at least 2 rounds) around mid-May 2027.

13.4 Organizers arrange on-site accommodation, golf rounds and meals; players cover transport to/from the venue, caddies and carts unless otherwise informed.

13.5 One practice round is provided.

13.6 Social events occur every evening except one, with live entertainment on at least one evening.

13.7 SA Final participants must sign the standalone Code of Conduct.

13.8 Players are responsible for travel costs and compliance with venue health protocols and associated costs.



14. Player Conduct

14.1 Participants are expected to uphold golf's values of respect, honesty, integrity and fun.

14.2 Full details are in the standalone Code of Conduct published in the website.

14.3 Environmental respect is encouraged: repair divots, rake bunkers and leave the course better than found — no trace left behind.

15. General Provisions

15.1 Amendments are notified via the web-app; continued participation constitutes acceptance.

15.2 Force majeure, privacy (data used solely for tournament administration and kept secure), liability (participation at own risk) and governing law (Republic of South Africa) apply.

16. Photographs and Media

16.1 By entering, players grant organizers permission to photograph or video for tournament promotion and advertising in any media, without further approval or payment.

16.2 Players release organizers from related claims.

17. Sponsorship

17.1 Sponsorship opportunities are available across stages, including division naming — contact admin to get involved!

18. Contact

18.1 Email: admin@asc.com

19. Acceptance

19.1 By registering, you confirm you have read, understood and agree to these rules.

Addendum 1:

ADDENDUM 1

UNIFIED MATCH DAY PROTOCOL

2026/27 Season



1. Executive Summary

- 1.1 This Addendum consolidates the best provisions from the Chat Suggestion framework and the Logistics Solutions package.
- 1.2 It provides clear, procedural rules with flexible problem-solving mechanisms designed to maximise tournament participation while minimising scheduling friction.

2. Core Principles

- 2.1 Working players (60% of base) have equal access to tournament participation.
- 2.2 Venue costs are predictable and fair; away teams are protected from unexpected expense.
- 2.3 Course closures are managed without forfeits; both teams share responsibility.
- 2.4 Clear escalation protocol ensures swift admin resolution (maximum 6 days).
- 2.5 The honour system prevents bureaucracy while maintaining competitive fairness.

3. Match Window

- 3.1 Each match shall be played within the scheduled round window.
- 3.2 The match window shall be divided into three phases:
 - 3.2.1 **Phase 1: Proposal Phase (Days 1–7)** — Home team initiates contact and proposes arrangements.
 - 3.2.2 **Phase 2: Agreement Phase** — Teams negotiate and reach consensus.
 - 3.2.3 **Phase 3:** The match is played.
- 3.3 Failure to reach agreement by the end of Day 7 shall result in both teams escalating the issue to admin for intervention.

4. Match Proposal (Home Team Responsibility)

- 4.1 The home team shall always strive to obtain the best possible green fee pricing from the club. Member–Guest rates shall apply at minimum.
- 4.2 The home team shall initiate contact and propose match arrangements within 7 days of the match release.
- 4.3 The proposal must include:
 - 4.3.1 A minimum of one (1) and a maximum of two (2) approved courses.
 - 4.3.2 A minimum of three (3) tee time options.
- 4.4 Proposed tee times must include at least one (1) of the following:
 - 4.4.1 A weekend option (Saturday or Sunday), and
 - 4.4.2 A weekday afternoon option (after 13:00 / 1:00 PM).
- 4.5 Proposals that consist only of weekday morning tee times shall be deemed unreasonable and non-compliant with this protocol.

5. Communication & Response Expectations



5.1 All communication between teams must take place via the official competition platform.

5.2 Both teams are required to:

5.2.1 Respond within 48 hours of any communication.

5.2.2 Act in good faith at all times.

5.3 Failure to respond within 48 hours shall constitute failure to engage and may trigger escalation.

6. Course Selection & Venue Cost Control

6.1 All matches must be played at courses within the officially approved Tier System.

6.2 Venue Cost Guideline:

6.2.1 The maximum accepted green fee is R600 per person.

6.2.2 If the home team proposes a venue exceeding R600, the away team may veto the proposed venue.

6.2.3 Both teams may mutually agree to exceed the R600 cap if consensus is reached.

6.2.4 The away team cannot unreasonably refuse a course that falls within the R600 guideline.

6.3 Veto Process:

6.3.1 If a veto occurs with less than 2 weeks' notice and without legitimate reason, the away team forfeits the match.

6.3.2 If a deadlock persists after 3 days, the matter shall be escalated to the Committee.

6.3.3 Upon escalation, admin shall request cost justification and facilitate a compromise.

7. Agreement Requirement

7.1 Both teams must agree on course, date, and tee time by no later than Day 7 of the matchplay round window.

7.2 Teams are encouraged to accept the earliest reasonable option presented by the other party.

7.3 If no agreement is reached by the end of Day 7, the matter shall automatically be escalated to admin.

7.4 Admin shall:

7.4.1 Assign a neutral venue.

7.4.2 Set a fixed date and tee time within the remaining play window.

7.4.3 Notify both teams within 24 hours.

7.5 The Committee's decision shall be final and binding. Both teams must comply.

8. Course Unavailability & Maintenance Closures



8.1 If a confirmed venue becomes unavailable due to maintenance (e.g. hollow tining), weather closure, or booking constraints, both teams must agree on a new venue as soon as possible.

8.2 Rescheduling Responsibility & Process:

8.2.1 Both teams share equal responsibility for finding an alternative.

8.2.2 The home team shall, within 72 hours of the closure notice, propose alternative course(s) within the remaining round window.

8.2.3 The away team shall respond within 48 hours with acceptance or a counter-proposal.

8.2.4 If the matter remains unresolved after the grace period, the win shall be awarded to the team with the fewest overall losses (see Rule 11.3.1.1 of the main Tournament Rules).

9. Rescheduling Restrictions

9.1 Once a match has been agreed and confirmed:

9.1.1 It may only be rescheduled once, and only by mutual consent.

9.1.2 Repeated postponements shall not be permitted.

9.1.3 Frivolous or vexatious cancellations may result in forfeiture.

10. Failure to Engage

10.1 A team shall be deemed to have failed to engage if it:

10.1.1 Does not respond within 48 hours to reasonable proposals.

10.1.2 Repeatedly ignores reasonable proposals.

10.1.3 Acts in a manner intended to delay or frustrate the scheduling process.

10.2 In such cases, the Committee may:

10.2.1 Award the match to the opposing team.

10.2.2 Issue penalties (e.g. reduced standing or future fixture disadvantage).

10.2.3 Disqualify the team in severe cases.

11. Failure to Play

11.1 If a match is not played within the 5-week window:

11.1.1 Where both teams are found responsible: The match shall result in a double forfeit.

11.1.2 Where one team is responsible: The match shall be awarded to the opposing team.

12. Match Day Requirements

12.1 All players must arrive at least 15 minutes prior to the scheduled tee time.

12.2 Rules of Golf regarding late arrival shall apply.



13. Financial Responsibility

13.1 Each player shall be responsible for their own green fees, cart fees, and any additional costs.

13.2 No team shall have any financial obligation toward the opposing team.

14. Priority 4 (Optional): Pre-Approved Venue List

14.1 Admin shall maintain a region-specific list of Tier 1 & Tier 2 compliant courses, sortable by cost and distance.

14.2 Teams may reference this list when disputes arise.

14.3 Benefit: This speeds up neutral venue assignments and reduces back-and-forth negotiation.